JIUZHEN DENG

New York, NY 10011 | (+1) 949-506-8647 | dengj599@newschool.edu | dengjiuzhen.github.io/studio

Research Interests

Interactive Narrative; Gameful Design; AI-Mediated Co-Creation; Embodied Experience; Participatory Fandom, Character Engagement, and Media Franchising; Social Connection and Informal Learning

Education

Master of Arts: ***Media Studies*** **Expected 05/2027**

Parsons School of Design | The New School New York City, NY, USA

- Key Courses: Media Practices: Programming | Media Practices: AI | Multisensorial Space Design | Immersive Narratives in VR/AR | Methods for Media Studies | Animating Resistance
- GPA: 4.0/4.0 | Media Management Graduate Certificate | Language Studies Graduate Minor (JPN)

Bachelor of Industrial Design: ***Industrial and Interaction Design*** **05/2024**

College of Visual and Performing Arts | Syracuse University Syracuse, NY, USA

- Key Courses: Design Research | Digital and Physical Intersect | Design Philosophy and Ethics
- GPA: 3.882/4.0 | Dean's List All Years | Completed 27-Credit Semester with all A's
- Minors: Japanese Studies | Photography, Video, and Design | Theater

Selected Research Projects and Conference Presentations

Master's Thesis (in progress) | *The New School*

Interactive Narrative, Anime Fandom, and AI-Mediated Character Engagement

- Designing a practice-based computational narrative system inspired by fan fiction and participatory fandom to investigate how AI-mediated co-creation shapes character engagement, narrative agency, and relationships with fictional worlds.

Creative Research Project | *The New School*

Research-through-design installation: Garden of Balloons - Synaesthetic Play and Collective Perception

- Designed and prototyped a participatory multisensory installation integrating touch, scent, sound, visual feedback, and collaborative physical interaction to explore embodied engagement and collective experience.
- Developed a Research-through-Design framework examining sensory coupling, embodied interaction, and temporal structuring.
- Presented at Critical Themes 2026: New Constructions, The New School. Related research published in the *Academic Journal of Management and Social Sciences* (2026).

Research Project | *The New School*

Anime Characters in Everyday Life: Attachment, Ritual, and Social Meaning in Contemporary Fandom

- Examined how anime characters become embedded in everyday practices through merchandise collection and ritualized engagement, investigating how character attachment mediates identity, belonging, and social connection.

Research Project | *The New School*

Narrating Success in Contemporary Anime: Platformized Subjectivity and the Cultural Logics of Datafied Growth

- ❖ Examined how contemporary anime narratives construct ideals of success and selfhood through platformization and datafied cultural logics.
- ❖ Presented at the *5th Global Conference on Media, Communication, and Film* (2026).

Research Project | *The New School*

Inside the Algorithmic Kaiwai: Negotiating Anime Subcultural Filter Bubbles

- ❖ Investigated how platform algorithms, industry marketing, character narratives, and fan participation shape anime communities and subcultural boundaries.
- ❖ Presented at the *4th Global Conference on Media, Communication, and Film* (2026).

Publications

- ❖ Deng, Jiuzhen. "Inside the Algorithmic Kaiwai: Negotiating Anime Subcultural Filter Bubbles." *Proceedings of the Global Conference on Media, Communication, and Film*, vol. 3, no. 1, 2026.
- ❖ Deng, Jiuzhen. "Designing Collective Experience: A Research-through-Design Framework for Gameful Multisensory Interaction." *Academic Journal of Management and Social Sciences*, vol. 17, no. 1, 2026.
- ❖ Deng, Jiuzhen. "Rethinking Creative Process with AI's Current Role and Future Potential." *GBP Proceedings Series: Science, Technology and Social Development*, 2025.
- ❖ Deng, Jiuzhen. "Designing Audience Flow State in Narrative Media." *Journal of Education, Humanities and Social Sciences*, 2025.
- ❖ Deng, Jiuzhen. "The Application of Dramatic Structure in Digital Game Design and Its Impact on Player Emotions." *Lecture Notes in Education Psychology and Public Media*, 2024.

Research and Creative Practice Experience

VR for Game Design and Immersive Storytelling **08/2024 to 03/2025**

Research Workshop | Mentored by faculty from the *University of California, Los Angeles*

- ❖ Investigated VR narrative affordances through immersive media research, Unity prototyping, and 360° video production, including the collaborative project *Telefuture*.
- ❖ Studied experimental storytelling and the history of immersive media.

Application of Psychological Principles in Game Design **08/2024 to 12/2024**

Research Seminar | Mentored by faculty from *Carnegie Mellon University* and *Beijing Normal University*

- ❖ Investigated how motivation, engagement, and affect inform gameful design, developing a narrative framework integrating psychological principles and dramatic structure through analysis of *What Remains of Edith Finch*.

Community Actors and Students' Theater Facilitator **08/2023 to 12/2023**

Syracuse Stage program at *Syracuse University*

- ❖ Designed and facilitated inclusive multi-arts theater activities for community actors with physical and learning disabilities, using movement, music, lighting, and handmade props to support creative expression and collective engagement.

Professional and Leadership Experience

Teaching Assistant **07/2026 to 08/2026**
JNC Study Abroad Platform, Feng Chia University Summer Session **Remote**
- ❖ Supported *Art History: Renaissance to Modern Art in the West* and *Intercultural Communication* courses by communicating with students, tracking attendance, coordinating assignments, and serving as a liaison across international student groups.

UX Design Intern **09/2024 to 05/2025**
Binesoft LLC **Alpharetta, Georgia**
- ❖ Contributed to UX design and experience flow development for a student-facing application initiative in collaboration with Kennesaw State University.
- ❖ Developed wireframes and interaction prototypes across multiple digital platforms.

Social Media Manager **11/2021 to 05/2024**
Syracuse University College of Visual and Performing Arts **Syracuse, New York**
- ❖ Managed digital communications and content strategy for the Industrial and Interaction Design program, promoting student work and program activities to expand audience engagement.

Student Ambassador, Peer Advisor **08/2023 to 05/2024**
Syracuse University **Syracuse, New York**
- ❖ Represented the School of Design in admissions, recruitment, and community-building initiatives.
- ❖ Mentored incoming students and supported their transition into university and academic life.

Marketing Design Assistant Intern **01/2024 to 01/2024**
Sheridonna Designs LLC **Burtonsville, Maryland**
- ❖ Supported branding, event planning, marketing materials, and digital outreach for commercial and nonprofit initiatives.

Promotions Design Manager **04/2021 to 10/2021**
Xishan Farm **Beijing, China**
- ❖ Developed promotional materials and managed social media communications supporting community engagement and organizational outreach.

Skills

Research Methods
- ❖ Research-through-Design
- ❖ Qualitative Research
- ❖ Narrative and Discourse Analysis
- ❖ Platform and Case Study Analysis

Design and Creative Practice
- ❖ Gameful Design
- ❖ Participatory Design
- ❖ Multisensory Experience Design
- ❖ Experimental Media Production

Creative & Computational Media
- ❖ Unity and XR Prototyping
- ❖ Creative Coding
- ❖ Interactive Systems Design
- ❖ Audiovisual Production

Languages
- ❖ Mandarin Chinese (Native)
- ❖ English (Fluent)
- ❖ Japanese (JLPT N1, 2025)